JOSEPH MCKENNA

Backend Engineer | Python | AWS Serverless & Event-Driven Systems
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PROFESSIONAL SUMMARY

Backend engineer specializing in Python and AWS-based distributed systems. Designs and operates scalable event-driven architectures processing thousands of healthcare transactions daily using Python, Lambda, SQS, and Step Functions. Experienced in building reliable cloud data pipelines, EDI processing systems, and fault-tolerant backend services. Currently pursuing a Master's in AI & Machine Learning with interest in building scalable analytics and ML platforms.

TECHNICAL SKILLS

Languages: Python, SQL, JavaScript
Frameworks & Libraries: Django, Django REST Framework, React
Databases: PostgreSQL, DynamoDB, SQL Server
AWS: Lambda, SQS, Step Functions, SNS, S3, CloudWatch
Architecture: Serverless architecture**,** event-driven systems, distributed processing, idempotent workflows
Infrastructure: Terraform, Docker, Git
Healthcare & Data Standards: ANSI X12 (837D, 837I, 837P), EDI processing, OCR pipelines

PROFESSIONAL EXPERIENCE

Gainwell Technologies — Remote **May 2022 - Present**
Backend Engineer | Professional Application Designer

• Designed and deployed in-house EDI X12 (837D, 837I, 837P) transaction infrastructure, eliminating offshore dependency and reducing vendor spending by $250K annually and increasing internal system ownership.
• Designed and implemented distributed Python-based AWS event-driven architecture using Lambda, SQS, and Step Functions to process 2,000+ healthcare claims daily with automated retries, dead-letter queues, idempotent processing, and fault-tolerant workflows.
• Architected OCR-to-EDI pipeline using AWS Textract to transform unstructured healthcare documents into compliant X12 transactions.
• Eliminated 30,000-document backlog by converting manual workflows into continuous, automated processing systems.
• Developed internal claims editing platform, increasing throughput and improving submission accuracy.
• Implemented centralized logging, monitoring, and alerting to reduce mean time to resolution (MTTR) for production incidents.
• Designed mapping and validation engines to ensure regulatory compliance and downstream system compatibility.

PROJECTS

22 to LIFE — Python, Django, React, AWS (Under Development)
Full-Stack Application | Veteran & First Responder Support Platform

• Designing full-stack platform supporting secure community interaction for veterans and first responders, focused on scalable user engagement and mental health resource integration.
• Architected backend services using Django REST framework to manage user authentication, profile management, secure messaging, and content moderation workflows.
• Built responsive frontend application using React, implementing dynamic state management, protected routes, and real-time user interaction features.
• Designed relational database schema to support user-generated content, community interactions, and scalable growth.
• Implemented role-based access controls and data validation to ensure secure handling of sensitive user information.
• Structured application to support future scalability, including potential integration with crisis resources, peer support matching, and external mental health services.

---------- **EDUCATION**----------

Master of Science — Artificial Intelligence & Machine Learning (In Progress) — Colorado State University Global
Bachelor of Science — Criminal Justice — Briarcliffe College
Full Stack Software Development Boot Camp — The Tech Academy